Making

"The sculptor acts on the bronze, and the statue is the bronze given a form, not a new thing. The camera is the same: light acts on the sensor, and the maker gives the picture its form."

The kind of answer: made · Making on the map

In a child's words. When you make something, you give a shape to stuff that was already there. You do not make the stuff.

The Institute habit

The Whisperer: a machine Mr. Curtain modelled on his own mind, which offered comfort and belonging, the things only persons give, and soothed a fear instead of answering it. Against it, Kate's red bucket: tools that serve the person who carries them.

The book

Mr. Curtain's plan, the white knight, and the end, where Reynie resists the Whisperer by facing the fear it wanted to soothe.

Week 1 · the kind of answer

Pack a bucket of your own and give a reason for every item. Monday puzzle: a control panel drawn with clues to find the one true OFF switch.

Week 2 · into the gap

Make a shoebox camera obscura and a figure in clay. The light acts and the maker frames; the clay is given a form and is still clay. Making is a gap on the map, so the child writes into it, in Mr. Benedict's voice: what I made, and what I did not.

Week 3 · the case

Peter Lombard allowed that God might give a minister the power to create; St Thomas Aquinas denied it. Try the rule on every person you know, the sculptor first, and it fails each time: no creature gives another

its being. The sculptor makes; he does not give being. Then ask what the Whisperer could do to a mind (rearrange it, hide its memories) and what it could never do (give one).

The workshop · suggested

For a child taking the Nand to Tetris strand, Project 2: the adders and the arithmetic unit. Every chip is NAND gates given a shape. The child makes something real and adds nothing to the gates, which is the unit's rule in silicon. Then ask what the Whisperer's maker could give it, and what he could not.

Fridays

The end-of-term trial: see Mr. Benedict's tests on the page for parents.

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Read online at canon-lawyer.ca/curriculum/making/.